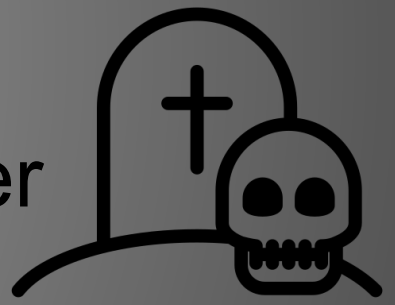
WORLD VIEW

The Big Questions of Life

Who am I?

What is the meaning of life?

Where do I go after death?



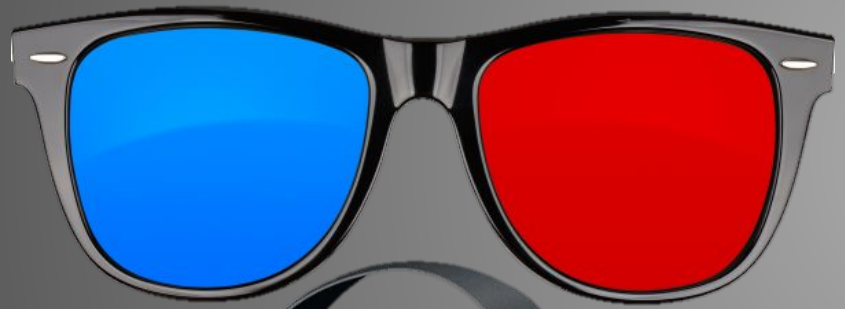
What is truth?

What is a Worldview?

Definitions

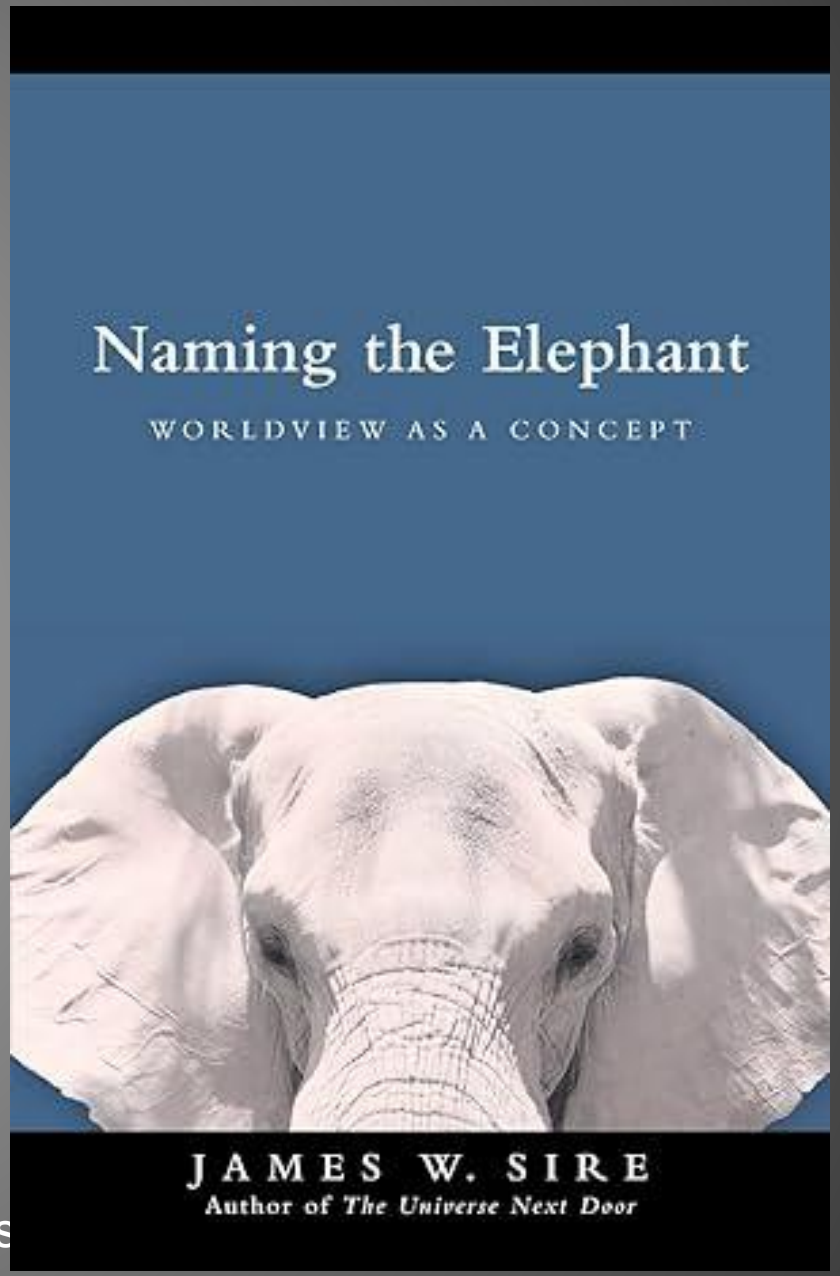
1. “A worldview may be defined as how one sees life and the world at large.

2. “A worldview may be defined as how one sees life and the world at large. In this manner it can be compared to a pair of glasses.' How a person makes sense of the world depends upon that person's vision, so to speak.”



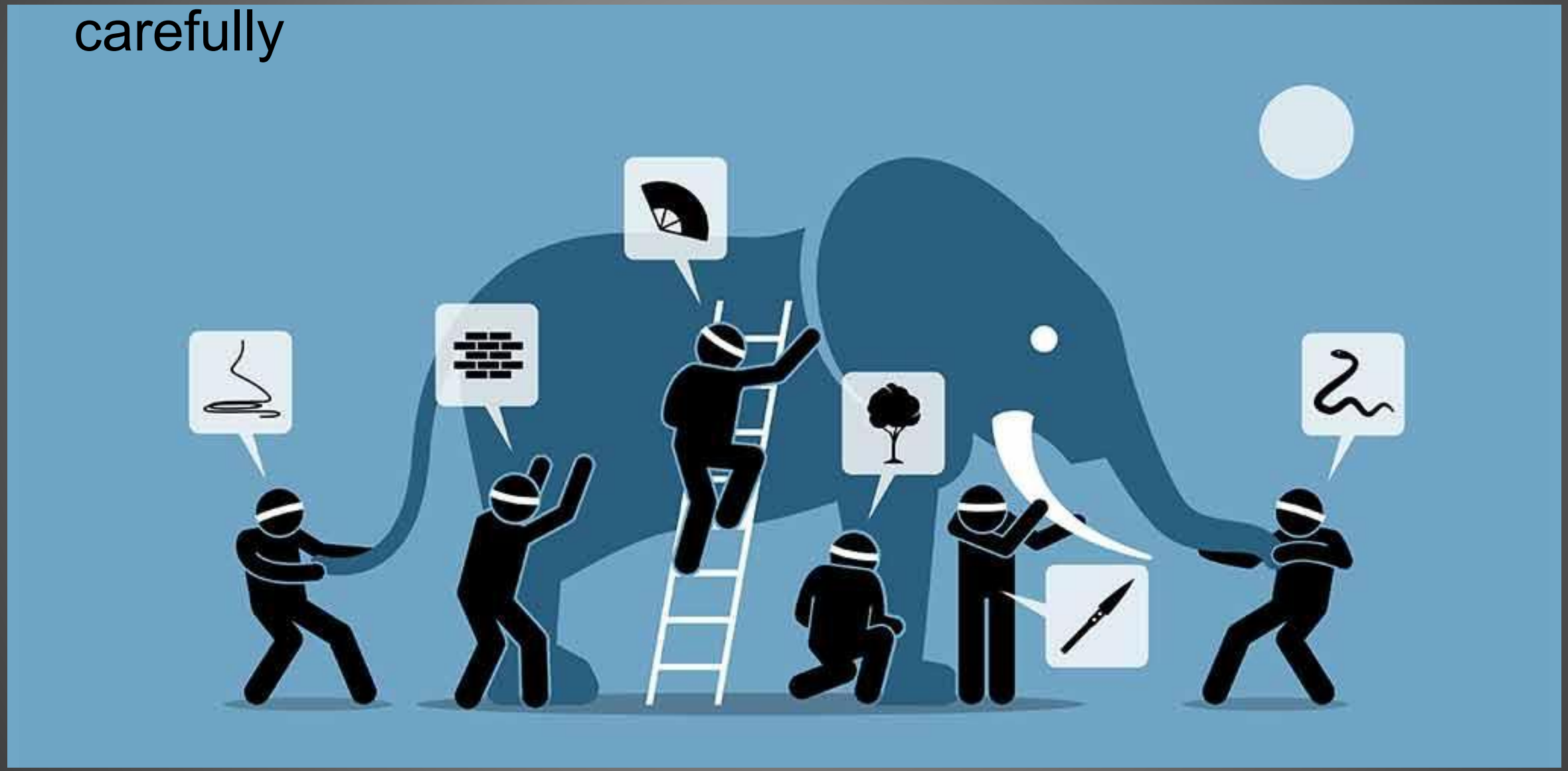
3. “The basic assumptions and guiding truths behind a culture. How we see our world. Unquestioned and usually unexamined assumptions we make about how and why society and life work.”

4. “A worldview is a commitment, the fundamental orientation of the heart, they can be expressed as a story or a set of presuppositions (assumptions, which may be true, partially true or entirely false) which we hold (consciously or subconsciously, consistently or inconsistently) about the basic constitution of reality, and that provides the foundation on which we live and move and have our being."



James W. Sire, *Naming the Elephant* (Downers Grove, IL: InterVars

The “elephant” is the concept of worldview itself: massive in importance, but elusive unless we define it carefully



A closer look at Sire's definition

1. Worldview as commitment

   a) Not simply a matter of the intellect

   b) Not a conscious decision

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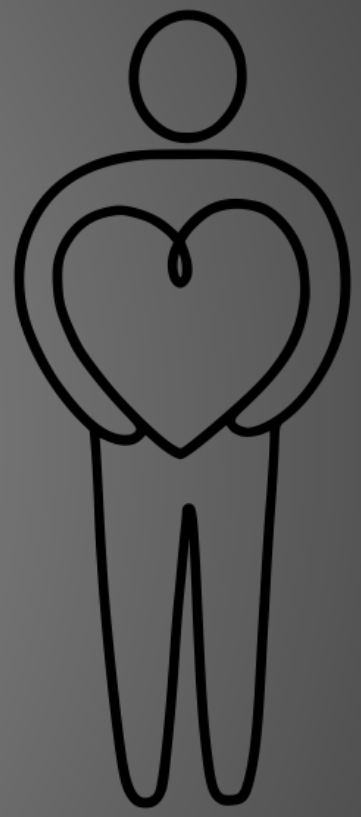
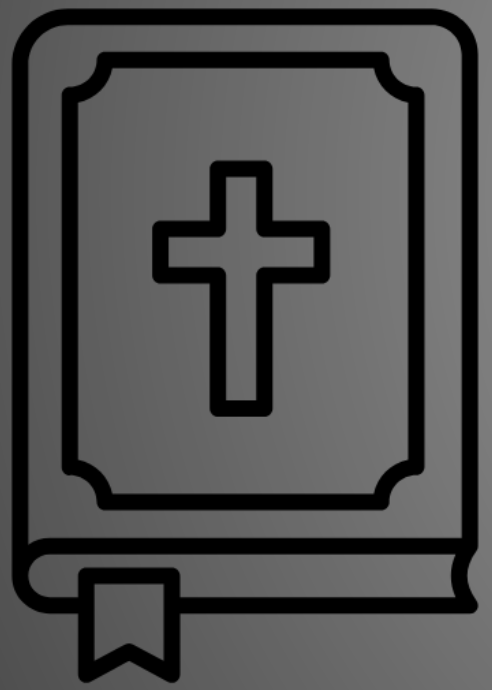
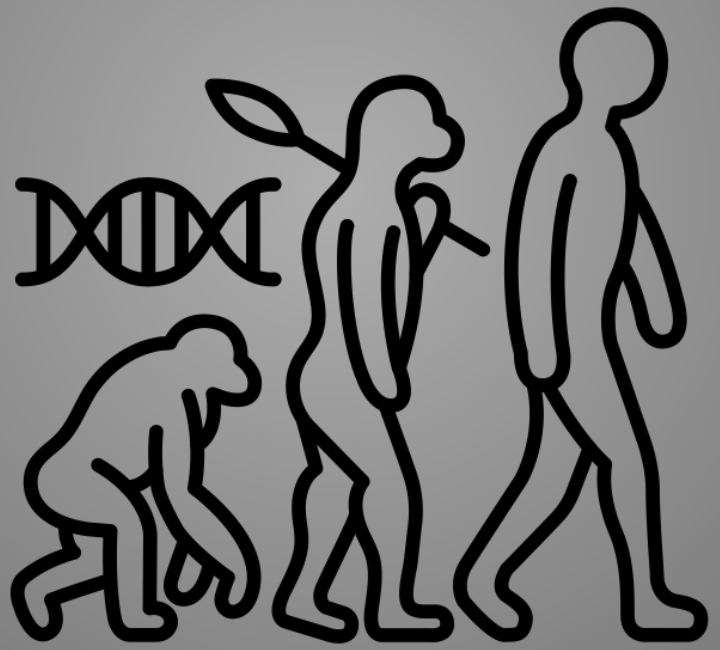
2. Worldview as a fundamental orientation of the heart



a) Below the conscious mind and directs the conscious mind

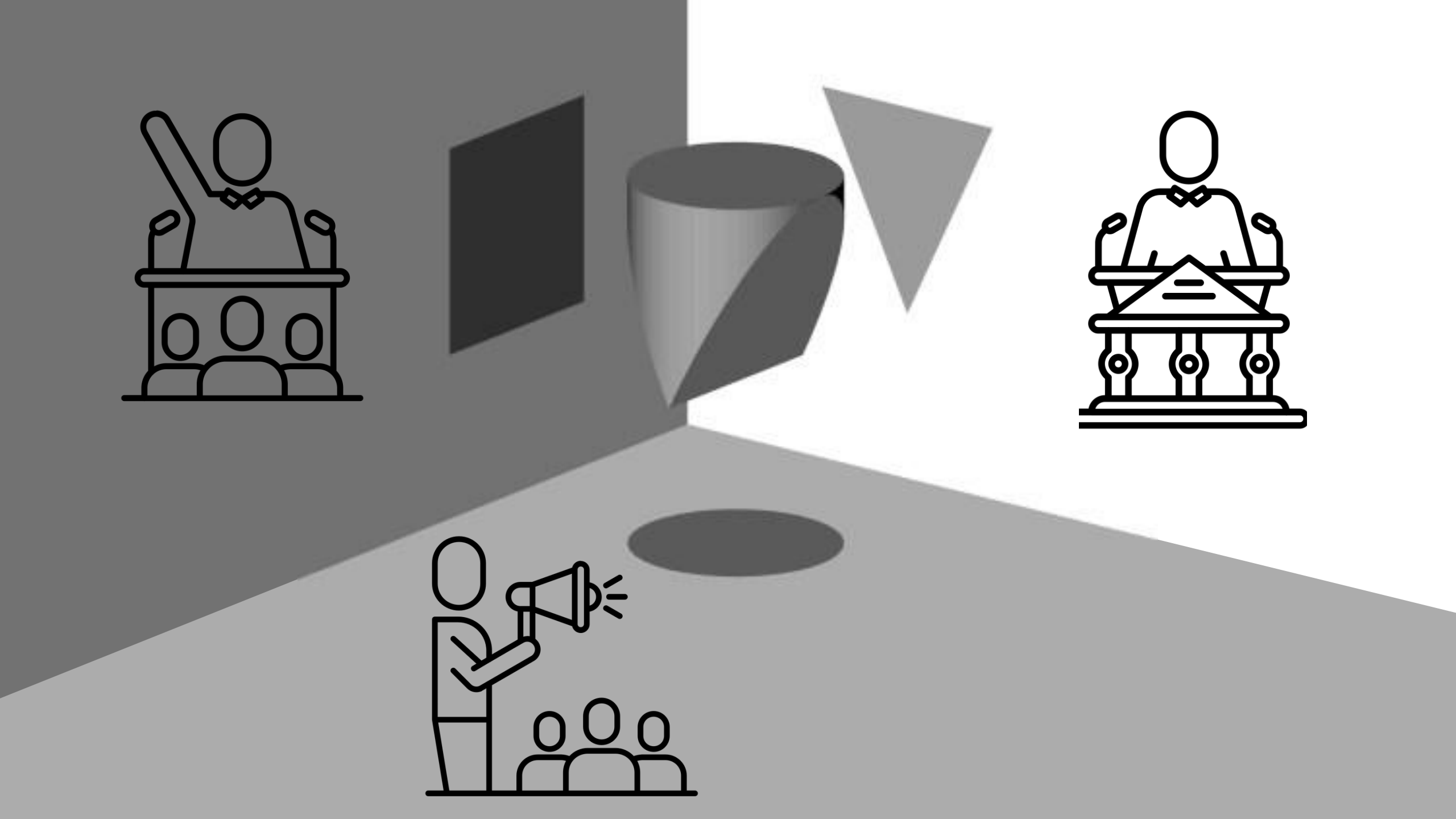
3. Expressed as a story or in a set of explicit presuppositions





4. Assumptions which may be true

a) Our presuppositions are limited in their accuracy

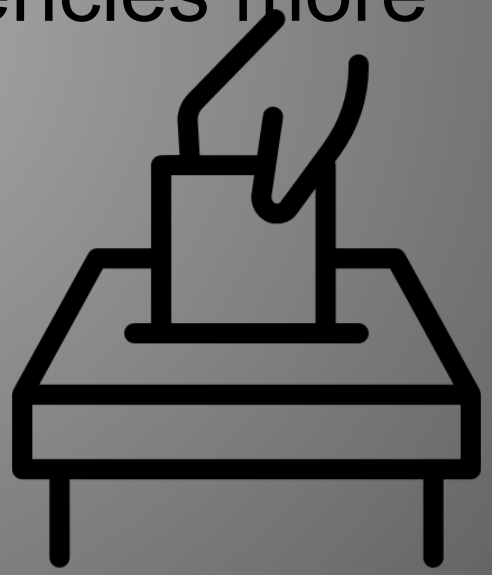


5. Presuppositions which we may hold consciously or unconsciously

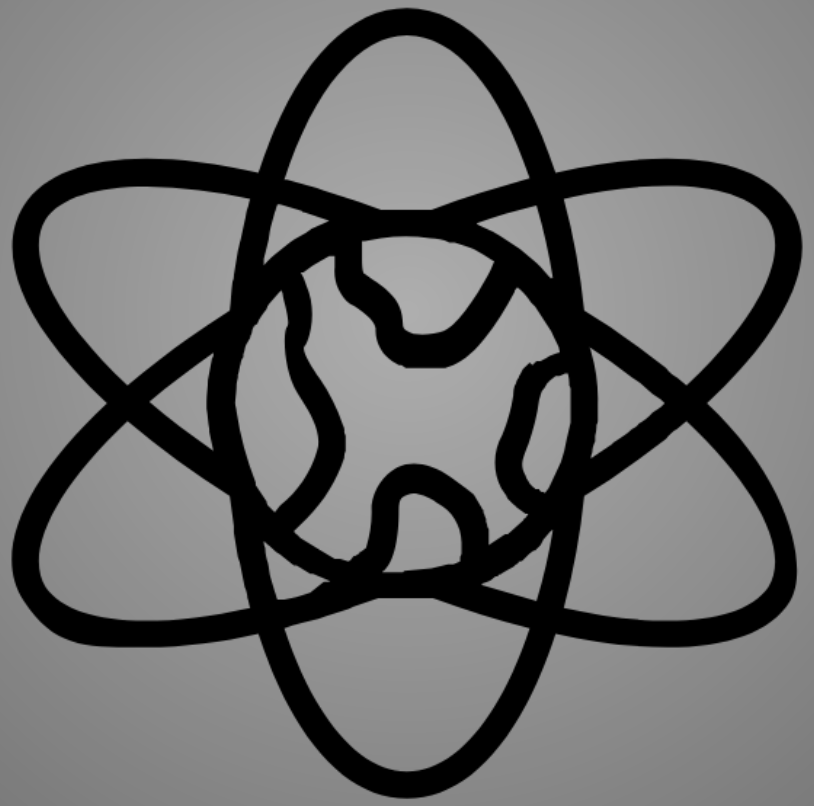
a) We all hold things to be true but do not think about them in a systematic way.

6. Presuppositions which are consistent or inconsistent

a) Cognitive dissonance causes us to be aware of and examine such inconsistencies more closely.

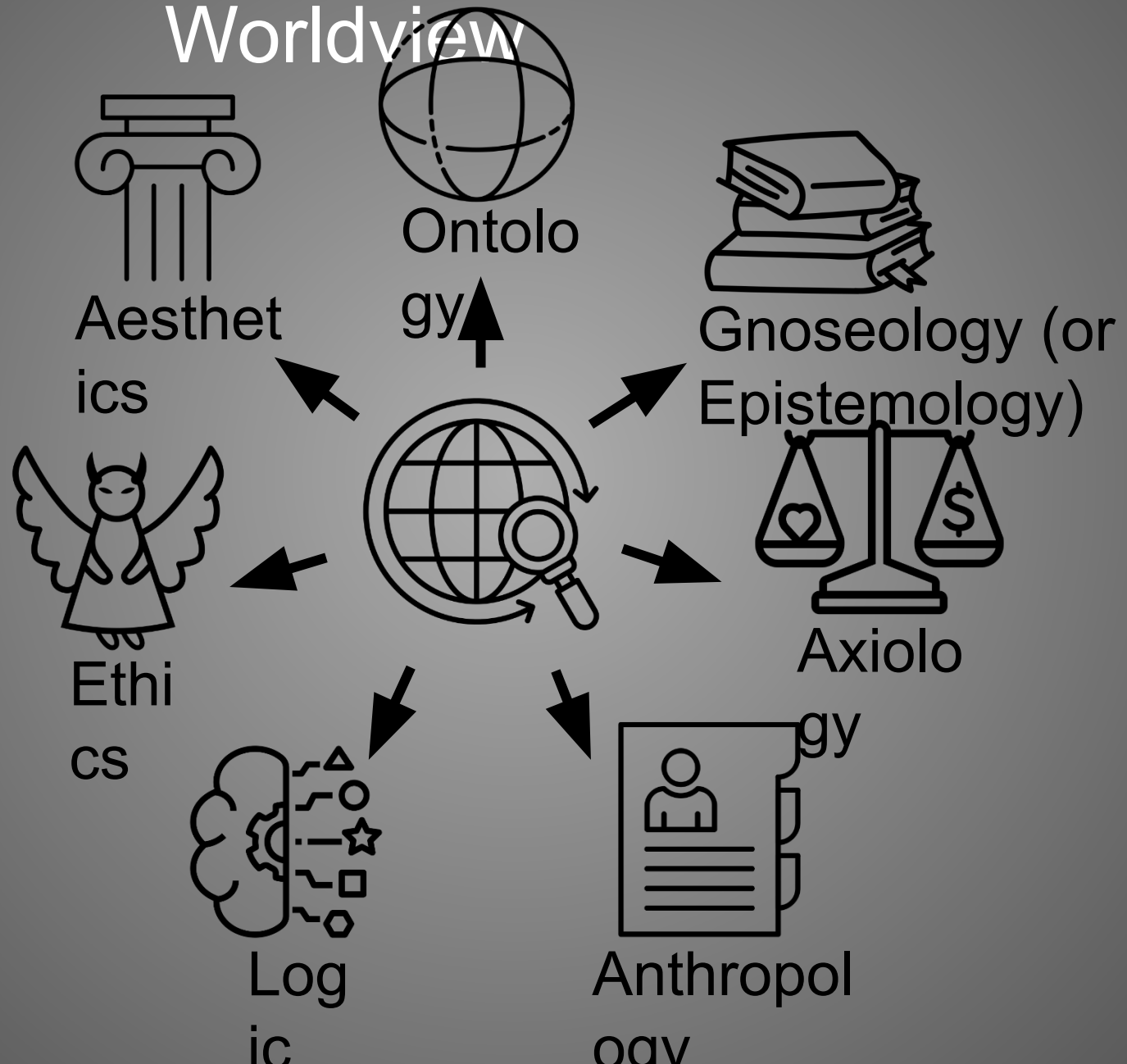


7. The basic constitution of reality

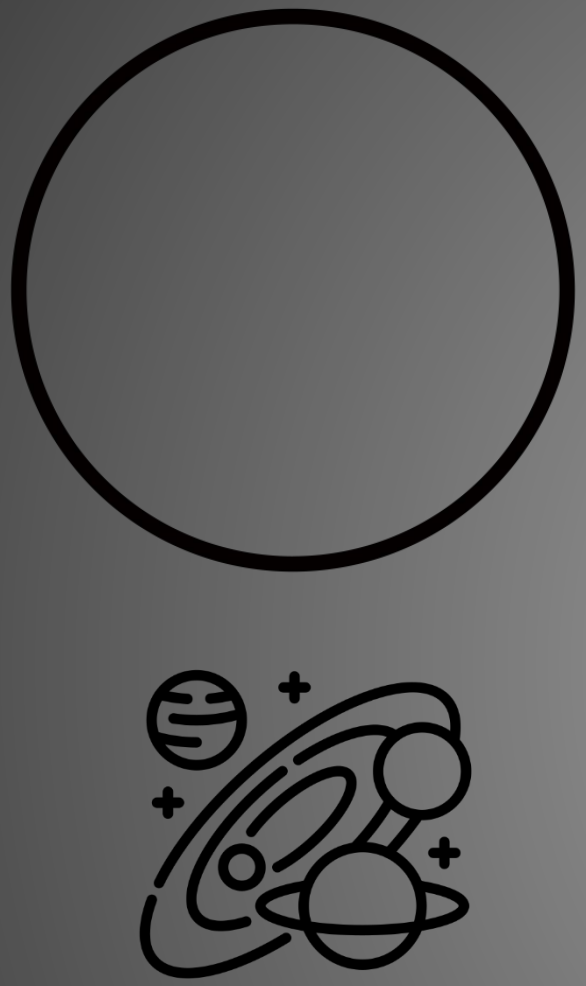


8. Provides the foundation on which we live

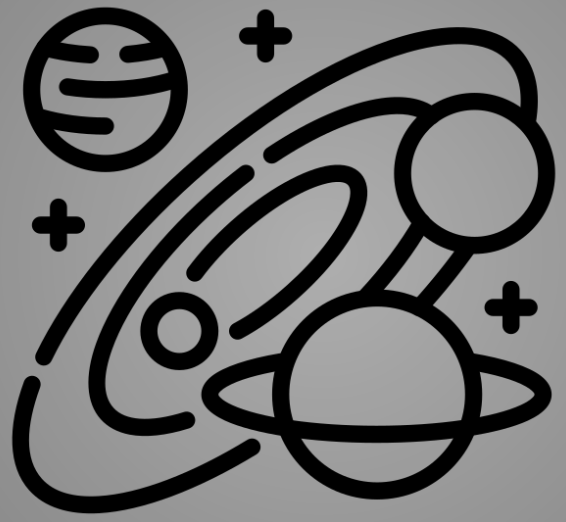
Categories of Worldview



Types Of Worldviews



Theism



Naturalism

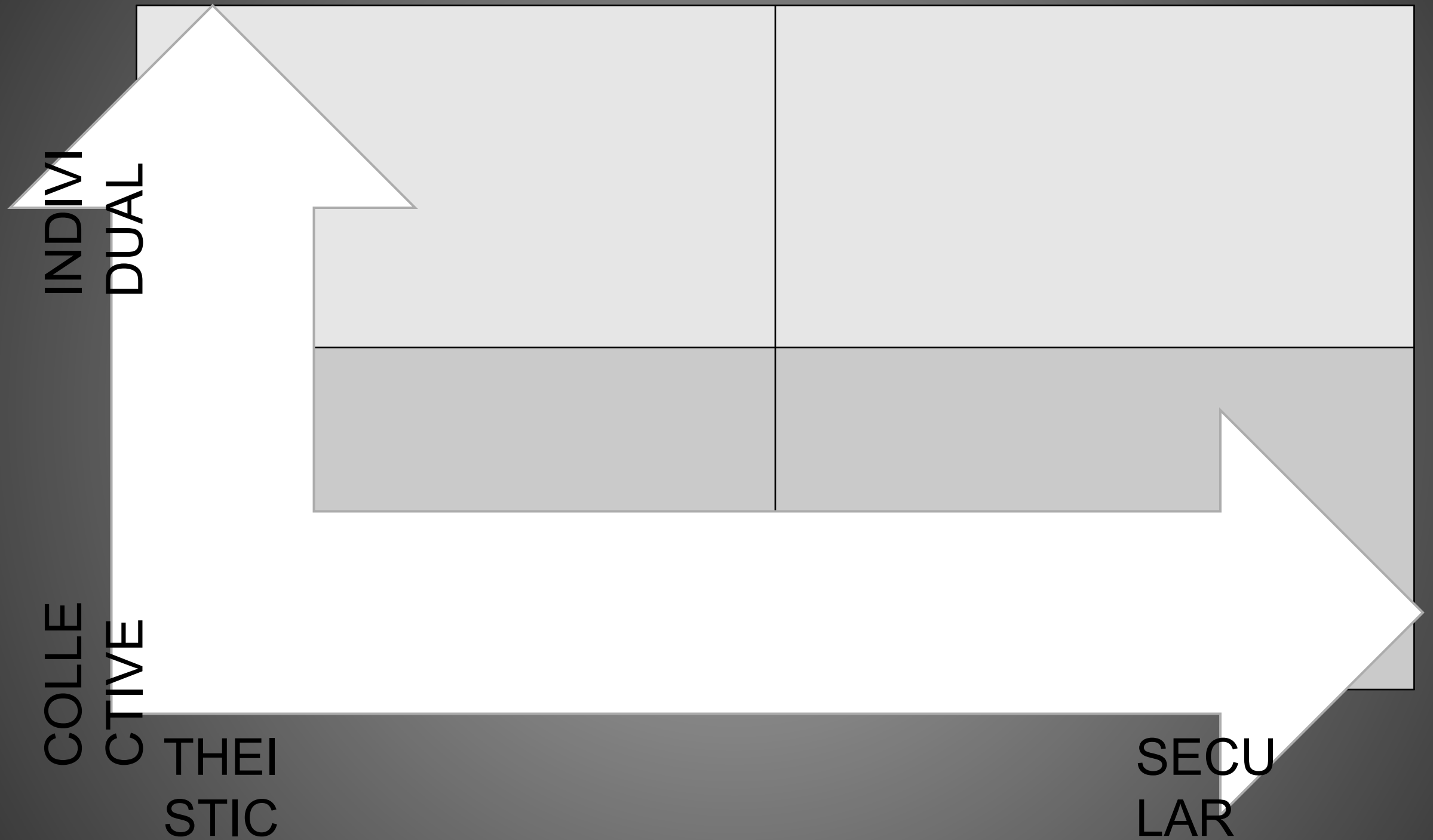
Pantheism

Worldview Comparison Table

Worldview	Core Story / Narrative	Ultimate Concern / Goal	Moral Guide / Ethics	View of Reality
Christian Theism	Creation, Fall, Redemption through Christ/Mesiah	Glory of God, theosis	Bible, conscience, love of God/neighbor	God-centered, supernatural reality exists
Judaism	Covenant with God, obedience and justice	Faithfulness to God, communal flourishing	Torah, mitzvot, tradition	God is personal; history unfolds according to covenant
Islamic Theism	Submission to Allah, life as test	Paradise and obedience to God	Qur'an, Sunnah, Sharia law	Allah is ultimate, world created for His will
Hinduism	Cycle of birth, karma, dharma	Moksha (liberation from samsara)	Dharma, scriptures (Vedas, Upanishads), spiritual practice	Reality is cyclical; multiple divine aspects
Buddhism	Life is suffering; path to enlightenment	Nirvana (cessation of suffering)	Eightfold Path, ethical precepts	Impermanence, no permanent self (anatman)

Secular Humanism	Humans are responsible for meaning	Human flourishing and well-being	Reason, empathy, social contracts	Naturalistic, no supernatural realm
Materialism / Naturalism	Only matter exists; life from nature	Survival, knowledge, progress	Scientific ethics, utilitarianism	Physical world only, causality rules
Postmodernism / Relativism	Truth and meaning are socially constructed	Autonomy, authenticity, pluralism	Contextual ethics, tolerance	Reality is subjective, fragmented
Existentialism	Life has no inherent meaning	Personal freedom and authenticity	Individual choice, responsibility	Reality is neutral; humans create significance
Marxism / Socialism	History shaped by class struggle	Classless society, justice	Collective welfare, equality	Material conditions shape society

New Age / Spiritual but not Religious	Personal spiritual growth	Self-realization, enlightenment	Intuition, inner guidance	Mystical, interconnected universe
Progressive Secularism / Liberalism	Society progresses through justice	Human rights, equality, environmental sustainability	Rights-based, social justice ethics	Social systems and institutions shape reality
Technological / Transhumanist	Human evolution enhanced by tech	Immortality, enhancement, optimization	Innovation, rational ethics, futurism	Physical and digital reality, malleable by technology
Consumerist / Market-Oriented	Life as pursuit of success and pleasure	Wealth, status, satisfaction	Market values, personal achievement	Material reality dominates; humans are consumers
Environmental / Ecocentric	Humans part of nature	Planetary balance, ecological flourishing	Stewardship, sustainability	Nature-centered; humans embedded in ecosystem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4 TYPES OF KNOWLEDGE

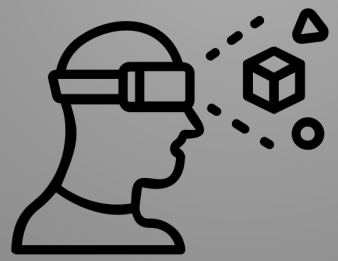
PROPOSITIONAL KNOWLEDGE

TO KNOW ABOUT SOMETHING

PROCEDURAL KNOWLEDGE

TO KNOW HOW TO DO SOMETHING

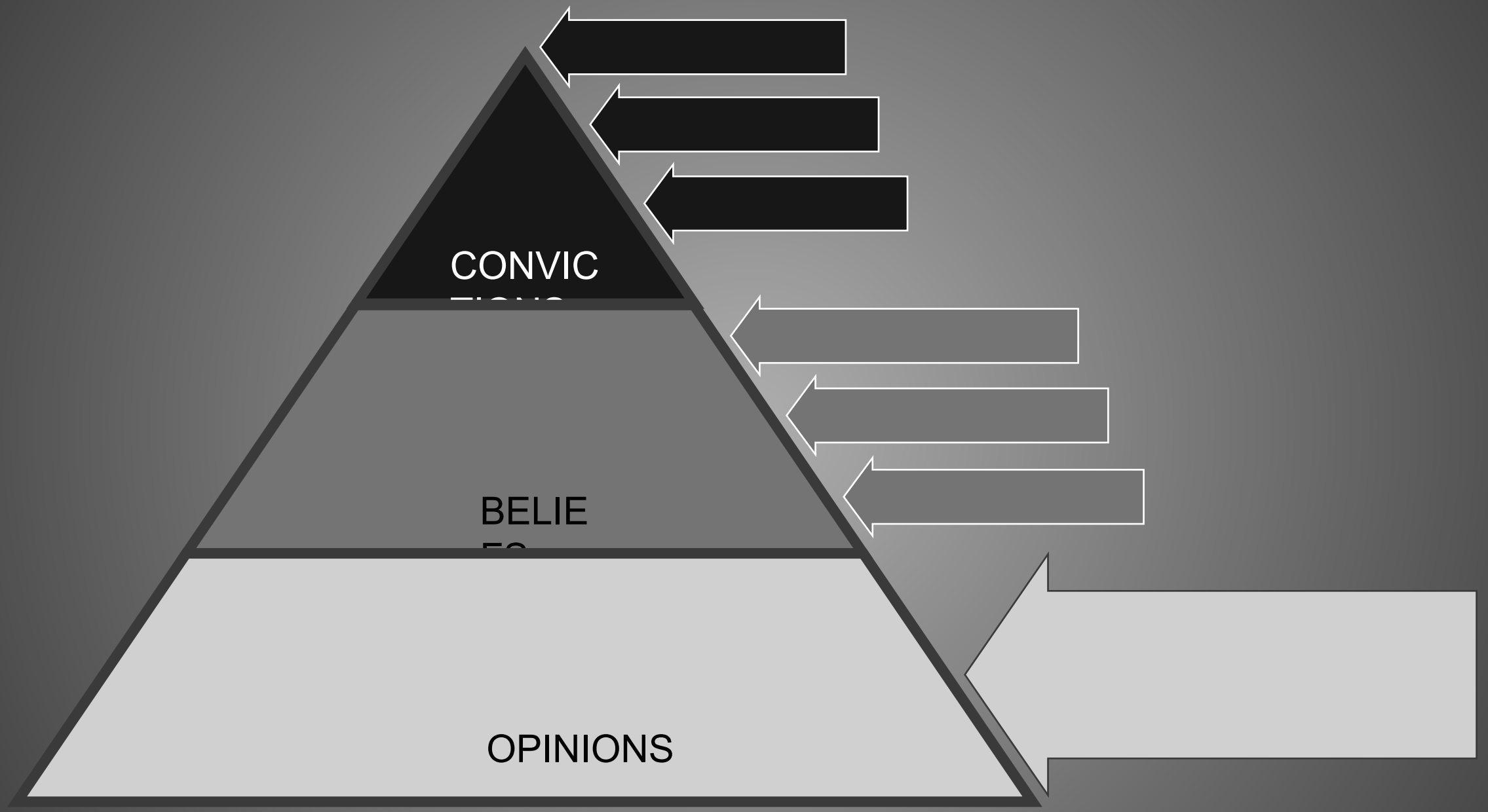
PERSPECTIVAL KNOWLEDGE



TO KNOW HOW TO PERCEIVE THE WORLD

PARTICIPATORY KNOWLEDGE

TO KNOW WHAT OUR PLACE IN THE WORLD IS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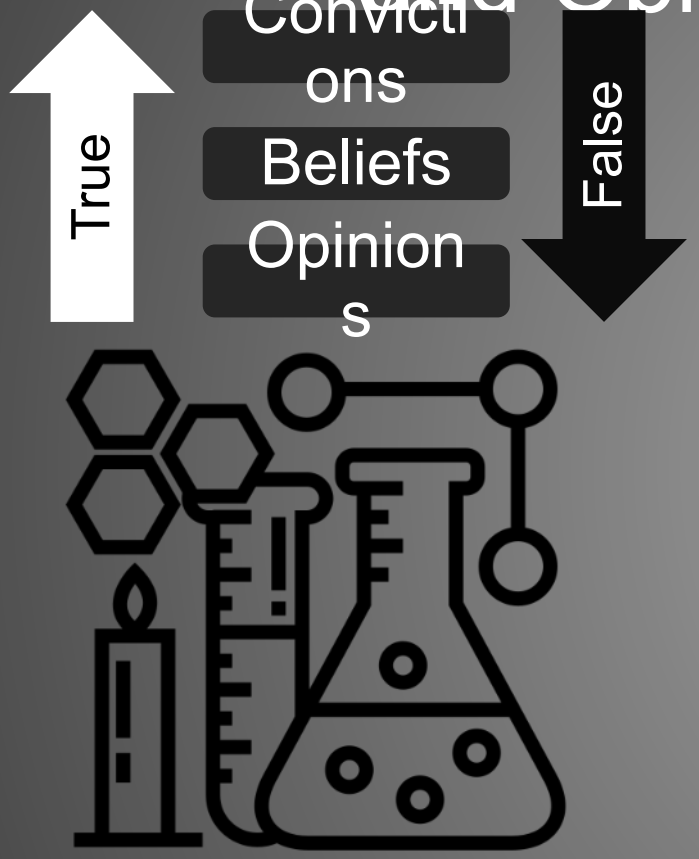
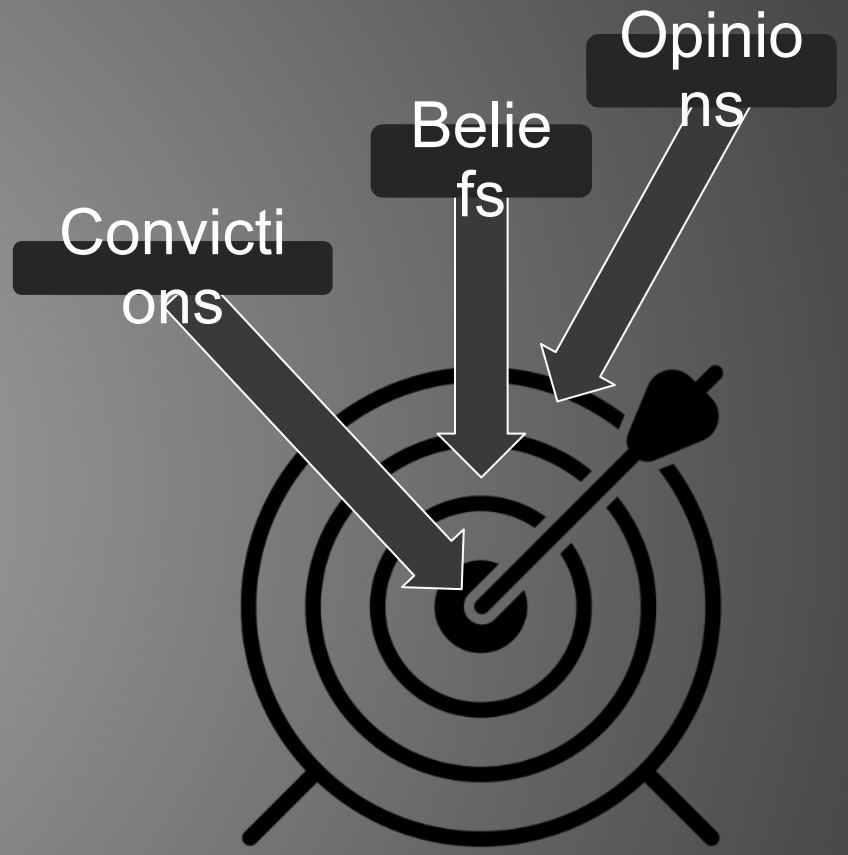
OPINIONS

Characteristics of Convictions, Beliefs, and Opinions



Content
(About what?)

Strength
(Resistance to skepticism)



Centrality
(How important is it?)